

ENTERING NIGHT: MOISHE'S WARNING AND THE SYMBOL OF NIGHT

Night by Elie Wiesel · pp. 3–22 · plus last night's reading check

NAME

DATE

CLASS

LEARNING TARGET

I can analyze how the people of Sighet respond to warnings and how Wiesel begins to use the word “night” as a symbol, and use evidence from the text to explain what those patterns reveal.

01

DO NOW

Silent. On your own. Use last night's reading.

5 MIN

Moishe returns to Sighet to warn the community about what he witnessed. **What does the community do with his warning, and WHY do you think they respond that way?** Use one detail from last night's reading.

MY RESPONSE

HOMEWORK COMPLETED? ☐ YES ☐ NO

02

FROM PLAY TO MEMOIR

Same history. A different way of telling it.

QUICK REFERENCE

PLAY

Playwrights shape a story for an audience. We experience the characters from the **outside**: dialogue, stage directions, performance.

MEMOIR

A survivor tells his **own** lived experience through memory and purpose. We are **inside** the narrator's perspective.

LENS 1 · ABOUT PEOPLE

How does this town respond every time danger gets closer?

LENS 2 · ABOUT LANGUAGE

What does Wiesel begin doing with the word “night”?

03

WARNING REACTIONS CHART

Warning → reaction → what the reaction reveals about people.

LENS 1

REREAD pp. 5–7. Mark your printed pages: **W** warning
R reaction **?** something to discuss

Column 3 is not a summary. It answers: what does this reaction reveal about what people do with unbearable news?

THE WARNING + PAGE	THE COMMUNITY’S REACTION + PAGE	INFERENCE: WHAT THIS REVEALS ABOUT PEOPLE
M pp. 6–7 · MOISHE Moishe escapes the Galician forest and comes back to describe what the Gestapo did there: “I wanted to come back to warn you.” (p. 7)	People “not only refused to believe his tales, they refused to listen.” Some said he wanted pity or was imagining things. Others said he had gone mad. (p. 7)	We build this one together.

SHOW YOUR THINKING · THINK FIRST, THEN SAY IT

Okay, now I need the inference. **What does their reaction to Moishe reveal about people?**

FIRST I NOTICED...

THEN I NOTICED THE PEOPLE...

SO I DECIDED THIS REVEALS...

BECAUSE...

BUILD · REVISE · CHALLENGE “I agree / would revise that because _____.”

PARTNERS · TALK IT OUT TOGETHER, EACH OF YOU WRITES

2	LOOK ON pp. 8–9 the war news, the Fascists take power, German troops enter Hungary, the report from Budapest		
3	LOOK ON pp. 9–12 German soldiers arrive in Sighet, the leaders are arrested, new decrees, the ghettos		

04

NIGHT TRACKER

Last night you noticed the word. Today we figure out what the pattern might mean.

LENS 2

SYMBOLISM = when a concrete image, word, object, or repeated detail carries a larger idea beyond its literal meaning.

WHERE “NIGHT” APPEARS, pp. 11–22: p. 12 · p. 14 · p. 18 · p. 21 · p. 22. Start with the ones you marked for homework.

	PAGE	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT “NIGHT” MIGHT SYMBOLIZE BEYOND LITERAL DARKNESS
M	p. 12 “Night fell.”	Neighbors gather in the courtyard. Elie’s father is suddenly called to a special Council meeting. “The story he had interrupted would remain unfinished.”	Watch Ms. Briggs think it through. Then write.
2	p. ____		
3	p. ____		
4	p. ____ if time		

PATTERN SENTENCE

Night keeps arriving with _____,
so Wiesel may be building “night” into a symbol of _____.

05

FOCUSED ANALYTICAL WRITE

Choose ONE prompt. Use your charts on pages 2–3.

10–12 MIN

- ☐ **PROMPT A · HUMAN NATURE**
What does the community’s response to the warnings reveal about human nature? Use evidence from the opening of *Night*.
- ☐ **PROMPT B · SYMBOLISM**
What might Wiesel’s repeated use of “night” symbolize in the opening of the memoir? Use evidence from the text.

- REQUIRED**
- ☐ **Claim:** What are you arguing?
 - ☐ **Evidence:** one strong line or detail + page
 - ☐ **Reasoning:** why that evidence supports your claim

TALK FIRST. Say your claim out loud to your partner in one sentence. Then write.

NEED A START? The community responds by _____. This reveals that people may _____ when _____. · Wiesel uses “night” when _____ is happening. This may symbolize _____ because _____. · This evidence supports my claim because _____.

MY RESPONSE

DONE EARLY? Add a second piece of evidence and the reasoning that goes with it.

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · EXIT TICKET · ON YOUR OWN

06 · EXIT TICKET · ANSWER THE ONE MS. BRIGGS CHOOSES

NAME

☐ **A.** One warning the people of Sighet fail to take seriously is _____. Their reaction reveals _____ about people.

OR

☐ **B.** So far, Wiesel’s repeated use of “night” may symbolize _____ because _____.

MY ANSWER